should be remembered that among the Shiite leaders in Iran and Iraq there is not only religious solidarity but also family ties. Many Shiite clerics from Iraq studied in Iran and at various points also sought political asylum there.

In light of all the above, today's world, with the United States at its helm, is at a crossroads; its attention is turning more and more toward postnuclear issues. One of them concerns what Iran's postnuclear strategy will be. In this context, there is a view that the attitude toward nuclear weapons is culturally dependent and not necessarily determined by military considerations. For example, the Soviet regime banned their bombers from flying freely over the skies of the Soviet Union with nuclear bombs on board. Why? To prevent a Soviet pilot from being tempted to drop a bomb on the Kremlin. Will the Iranians also think this way? Will they ensure that a missile launcher with a nuclear warhead can under no circumstances direct a missile at an Iranian target?

Another issue is that Iran's nuclearization is likely to lead to increased demand for nuclear technology in the Middle East. Those who will undoubtedly star in this show will be members of the group known as the "A. Q. Khan boys" (Abdul Qadeer Khan was the undisputed leader of the Pakistani nuclear project and is the world's number one proliferator of nonconventional weapons). If this happens, very little will remain of the global nonproliferation regime to which President Obama devoted so much of his time, because the North Koreans, the Chinese, and even the Russians will want to take part in this lucrative market.

A third issue concerns nuclear deterrence. We are familiar with the concept of the unitary deterrence rational actor, whereby, in the dialectic of nuclear theories, logic prevails for everyone in all cases, leading the nuclear states to tone down the conflict between them. The answer to the question of whether these rules will apply in the case of Iran is not evident. Our judgment of what is rational refers to everything that is reasonable in our eyes and ignores fundamental differences in the adversary's database, the filters through which it sees things, the focus of its identity (Its country? Its religion? Its culture?).

In this context, it is worth mentioning the US Department of Defense's practice of "deterrence profiling." This profile includes the following elements: the enemy's history, its self-image, the degree to which it complies with authority, its past responses to reward and punishment, its sources of motivation (be they religious, economic, ideological, political,